

# Focus Group Report — vercel.com

3 personas | 2026-05-18

## Headline

Vercel successfully converted all three personas with clear pricing transparency and compelling AI features. The website effectively addressed diverse technical comfort levels, though some personas needed additional sales demos to finalize decisions.

### Strengths

- Clear, predictable pricing structure with free tier and spend limits that addressed budget concerns across all personas
- Strong AI feature positioning that resonated with both enterprise and indie developer needs
- Compelling case studies and performance metrics that demonstrated clear business value
- Accessible information architecture that worked well for different technical comfort levels
- Helpful AI chat feature that provided specific technical clarifications

### Weaknesses

- Some personas still needed sales demos to get complete answers about workflows and integrations
- Content management and non-technical team member workflows not immediately clear from self-service exploration

### What we couldn't fully observe

# 75%

QUESTIONS ANSWERED

7/7 — Marcus Chen

3/8 — Sarah Okafor

7/8 — David Kim

AVG RATING

4.0/5

CONVERSION RATE

100%

TOP DECISIONS

- recommend Pro plan trial
- schedule demo with sales team
- sign up for free account

Some parts of the site couldn't be fully experienced by the personas:

- Sign-in required on 1 page (e.g., Login - Vercel) -- personas couldn't see the content behind the gate.
- 3 interactive areas drawn with <canvas> (think Figma or a game) -- personas can see them but can't read or click meaningfully.
- Personas picked 1 interactive widget (Ask a question...); personas don't operate its contents.
- 1 off-site destination (e.g., lead-agent.vercel.sh) were viewed but not browsed further -- personas could read the page text but couldn't click into anything, because the destination lies outside the evaluated site.

**Recommendations**

1. Enhance self-service content about content management workflows and team collaboration features to reduce dependency on sales demos
2. Expand case study library with more diverse company sizes and use cases to improve persona relevance
3. Create clearer pathways from AI feature discovery to technical implementation details for developer personas

Detailed findings

**Conversion rate:** 3 of 3 personas (100.0%) engaged with a sales or contact channel during their visit.

On average, personas were able to answer **75.0%** of their questions using the website.

Outcomes (one bucket per persona)

**Conversions**

- indicated they would call the business × **2**
- indicated they would buy, order, or sign up online × **1**

**Rating Averages**

| Category        | Average |
|-----------------|---------|
| Ease Of Use     | 4.0/5   |
| Informativeness | 4.0/5   |

| Category              | Average |
|-----------------------|---------|
| Overall Impression    | 4.0/5   |
| Ease Of Understanding | 4.3/5   |

## Most Used Interactions

| Interaction                                                         | Type          | Times Used |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------|
| Pricing                                                             | link          | 3          |
| Back                                                                | back          | 3          |
| Leave                                                               | leave         | 3          |
| <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scroll_down   | 3          |
| Products                                                            | menu_toggle   | 2          |
| Resources                                                           | menu_toggle   | 2          |
| Solutions                                                           | menu_toggle   | 2          |
| Ask AI                                                              | button        | 2          |
| Search                                                              | search_action | 2          |
| Ask a question...                                                   | form          | 2          |
| <a href="#">link to /home</a>                                       | link          | 1          |
| Log In                                                              | link          | 1          |
| Talk to an Expert                                                   | link          | 1          |
| Templates                                                           | link          | 1          |
| Use Case                                                            | button        | 1          |
| Getting Started                                                     | link          | 1          |
| Flags                                                               | link          | 1          |
| paige Logo With Vercel, PAIGE boosted their Black                   | link          | 1          |
| Lead Agent An inbound lead qualification and resea                  | link          | 1          |
| Read the Docs                                                       | link          | 1          |

Never discovered by any persona:

- AI Apps AI Apps (menu\_toggle)
- Web Apps Web Apps (menu\_toggle)
- Ecommerce Ecommerce (menu\_toggle)
- Marketing Marketing (menu\_toggle)
- Platforms Platforms (menu\_toggle)
- AI SDK (menu\_toggle)
- Python (menu\_toggle)
- OpenAI HTTP (menu\_toggle)
- Copy code (button)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Expertise (menu\_toggle)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Framework (menu\_toggle)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Budget (menu\_toggle)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Tier (menu\_toggle)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Certification (menu\_toggle)
- SolutionPartnersFilter by Region (menu\_toggle)

Persona experiences

Detailed records of each persona's visit — narrative, reactions, decisions, interaction log, and questions resolved.

| Name         | Age | Intent                                              | Details                                                                           |
|--------------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Marcus Chen  | 28  | Evaluating deployment platform options              | Team of 4 developers, need AI capabilities, looking to reduce deployment friction |
| Sarah Okafor | 41  | Researching modern web platform for marketing sites | 6-week deadline, needs fast pages, team includes non-developers                   |

| Name      | Age | Intent                                    | Details                                                                  |
|-----------|-----|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| David Kim | 34  | Exploring AI-focused development platform | Solo developer, tight budget under \$200/month, building AI writing tool |

## Persona 1: Marcus Chen, 28

Evaluating deployment platform options (Team of 4 developers, need AI capabilities, looking to reduce deployment friction) -- Austin, TX

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### Personal Description

Marcus graduated from UT Austin with a Computer Science degree three years ago and works at a 15-person fintech startup. He's primarily responsible for their React-based customer dashboard but increasingly gets pulled into full-stack work. He's comfortable with modern JavaScript frameworks but sometimes feels overwhelmed by the rapidly changing deployment and infrastructure landscape. He spends evenings working on side projects and is always looking for tools that can help him ship faster without getting bogged down in DevOps.

### Situation

Marcus's startup is planning to rebuild their customer onboarding flow, and his CTO mentioned they should explore modern deployment platforms that can handle both their main app and some AI-powered features they want to add. The company currently uses a basic DigitalOcean setup that requires manual deployment steps, and Marcus has been tasked with researching alternatives. He's heard Vercel mentioned in developer Twitter threads and wants to understand if it could replace their current infrastructure while supporting their plans to integrate AI features for document processing.

### Key Questions

- Can Vercel handle both our React frontend and Node.js API in a single deployment?
- How easy is it to integrate AI models for document processing workflows?
- What would migration from our current DigitalOcean setup look like?
- How does pricing scale as we grow from 500 to 5000+ users?
- Can multiple developers deploy preview environments without conflicts?

- Does the AI Cloud actually simplify ML model deployment or is it just marketing?
- What happens if Vercel has an outage - how reliable is this compared to managing our own servers?

## **What They Need**

Marcus needs clear technical documentation and concrete examples showing how Vercel works with his existing tech stack. He wants to see real code examples, understand the migration path, and get honest information about limitations and costs. As someone who will need to present this to his team, he needs compelling evidence that this is worth the switch.

## **Visit Experience**

When I first landed on Vercel's site, I was skeptical about whether their 'AI Cloud' was real infrastructure or just marketing buzzwords. My CTO had mentioned them as a potential replacement for our DigitalOcean setup, but I needed concrete evidence. I started by exploring their pricing page, which gave me clear information - Pro plan at \$20/month with usage-based billing and spend limits, much more predictable than our current always-on server costs. The AI chat feature helped clarify their pricing tiers, showing they have SOC compliance which is crucial for our fintech requirements. When I discovered the Neo Financial case study, everything clicked. Here was another fintech startup that migrated from AWS infrastructure (similar to our DigitalOcean setup) and achieved a 50% reduction in infrastructure admin time, 77% faster page loads, and multiple daily deployments through preview environments. Reading about their security certifications and 99.99% SLA gave me confidence about reliability. The AI Cloud section showed real infrastructure - AI Gateway for model management, Fluid Compute for AI workloads, and Sandbox for secure execution - not just marketing fluff.

## **Questions Answered by the Site**

The site answered most of my critical questions quite well. Pricing information was clearly laid out with specific tiers and usage-based billing that would scale with our growth. The Neo Financial case study directly addressed migration from similar infrastructure, team collaboration through preview deployments, and reliability for fintech applications. The AI Cloud section provided detailed information about their AI infrastructure capabilities. However, I couldn't find explicit information about deploying React frontend and Node.js API together in a single deployment - while the site mentioned full-stack capabilities and serverless

functions, the specific technical architecture for our use case wasn't clearly documented. The migration process details were also somewhat vague beyond the general benefits Neo Financial achieved.

## **Reaction**

I was initially skeptical but became increasingly impressed as I dug deeper. The Neo Financial case study was particularly compelling because it showed real results from a company facing similar challenges to ours. I felt confident about their security and compliance capabilities for fintech applications, and the pricing transparency was refreshing compared to the unpredictable costs we face with our current setup. The AI infrastructure appeared legitimate and comprehensive, which addressed my concerns about it being just marketing hype. Overall, I felt like this could solve many of our current infrastructure headaches.

## **Decision & Next Steps**

I'm going to recommend to our CTO that we start with a Pro plan trial to test our React app deployment and AI integration capabilities. I'll also request a demo to get specific answers about full-stack deployment architecture and migration process. Given the strong evidence from Neo Financial's success and the clear cost benefits, this seems like a worthwhile investment to reduce our infrastructure overhead and improve development velocity.

## **Interaction Log**

| # | Action      | Target                                                              | Result                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | menu_toggle | Products                                                            | menu toggle<br>'Products' click failed;<br>strategy_errors:<br>dom_anchor=None:<br>walker did not store one / get_by_text:<br>TimeoutError:<br>Locator.click:<br>Timeout 2000ms exceeded. Call log: - waiting for<br>get_by_text("Products", exact=True).first - locator resolved to<br><button value="features" / has-text selector:<br>TimeoutError:<br>Page.click: Timeout 2000ms exceeded. Call log: - waiting for<br>locator("summary:has-text('Products'), button:has-text('Products')") - locator resolved to<br><b |
| 2 | link        | Pricing                                                             | navigated to Vercel Pricing: Hobby, Pro, and Enterprise plans                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 3 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/67                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 4 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/67                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 5 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/67                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 6 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/67                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

| #  | Action             | Target                                                              | Result                                                    |
|----|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 7  | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 6/67                              |
| 8  | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 7/67                              |
| 9  | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 8/67                              |
| 10 | button             | Ask AI                                                              | content expanded on page                                  |
| 11 | button             | How much does Vercel cost?                                          | content expanded on page                                  |
| 12 | widget_interaction | Ask a question...                                                   | couldn't operate widget 'Ask a question...'               |
| 13 | button             | Close chat                                                          | button clicked, no visible change (network_only)          |
| 14 | menu_toggle        | Products                                                            | opened menu toggle 'Products', revealing 15 new option(s) |
| 15 | link               | AI Cloud                                                            | navigated to Deploy AI at the speed of frontend           |
| 16 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 2/32                              |
| 17 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 3/32                              |
| 18 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 4/32                              |
| 19 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 5/32                              |
| 20 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 6/32                              |
| 21 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>           | scrolled down to screen 7/32                              |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                    | Result                                                                                |
|----|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 22 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>                                 | scrolled down to screen 8/32                                                          |
| 23 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>                                 | scrolled down to screen 9/32                                                          |
| 24 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai">https://vercel.com/ai</a>                                 | scrolled down to screen 10/32                                                         |
| 25 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a>                       | navigated back                                                                        |
| 26 | menu_toggle | Solutions                                                                                 | opened menu toggle 'Solutions', revealing 10 new option(s)                            |
| 27 | link        | Web Apps Ship features, not infrastructure                                                | navigated to Create personalized web apps with Vercel                                 |
| 28 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps">https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/32                                                          |
| 29 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps">https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/32                                                          |
| 30 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps">https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/32                                                          |
| 31 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps">https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/32                                                          |
| 32 | link        | "Our core business is banking and financial services so now we are able to inves          | navigated to How Neo Financial cut time spent on infrastructure admin by 50% - Vercel |
| 33 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/28                                                          |
| 34 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/28                                                          |
| 35 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/28                                                          |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                    | Result                                                                           |
|----|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 36 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/28                                                     |
| 37 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 6/28                                                     |
| 38 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 7/28                                                     |
| 39 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 8/28                                                     |
| 40 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 9/28                                                     |
| 41 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 10/28                                                    |
| 42 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 11/28                                                    |
| 43 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 12/28                                                    |
| 44 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 13/28                                                    |
| 45 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 14/28                                                    |
| 46 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 15/28                                                    |
| 47 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 16/28                                                    |
| 48 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial">https://vercel.com/blog/neo-financial</a> | scrolled down to screen 17/28                                                    |
| 49 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps">https://vercel.com/solutions/web-apps</a> | navigated back                                                                   |
| 50 | link        | link to /home                                                                             | navigated to Vercel: Build and deploy the best web experiences with the AI Cloud |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                        | Result                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 51 | menu_toggle | Resources                                                     | menu toggle<br>'Resources' click failed;<br>strategy_errors:<br>dom_anchor=None:<br>walker did not store one / get_by_text:<br>TimeoutError:<br>Locator.click:<br>Timeout 2000ms exceeded. Call log: - waiting for<br>get_by_text("Resources", exact=True).first - locator resolved to<br><button value="resources" / has-text selector:<br>TimeoutError:<br>Page.click: Timeout 2000ms exceeded. Call log: - waiting for<br>locator("summary:has-text('Resources'), button:has-text('Resources')") - locator resolved to |
| 52 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/home">https://vercel.com/home</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/30                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 53 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/home">https://vercel.com/home</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/30                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 54 | leave       |                                                               | left the website                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

**Questions Resolved**

| Question                                                                          | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can Vercel handle both our React frontend and Node.js API in a single deployment? | Yes     | No         | The site mentioned serverless functions, Fluid Compute for backend workloads, and Next.js integration, but I couldn't find explicit documentation showing how React frontend and Node.js API deploy together. The technical architecture for full-stack deployment wasn't clearly explained. |
| How easy is it to integrate AI models for document processing workflows?          | Yes     | Yes        | The AI Cloud section showed comprehensive infrastructure including AI Gateway for model management, Fluid Compute for AI workloads, and Sandbox for secure execution. The marketplace diagram showed integration with multiple AI providers through a single interface.                      |
| What would migration from our current DigitalOcean setup look like?               | Yes     | No         | Neo Financial's case study showed the benefits of migrating from AWS Fargate (similar to our setup) but lacked specific technical details about the migration process, timeline, or potential challenges. The results were clear but the 'how' was vague.                                    |
| How does pricing scale as we grow from 500 to 5000+ users?                        | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing page clearly showed Pro plan at \$20/month per seat with usage-based billing beyond included credits, plus spend limits to control costs. This pay-for-what-you-use model would scale much better than our fixed server costs.                                                   |

| Question                                                                                          | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can multiple developers deploy preview environments without conflicts?                            | Yes     | Yes        | Neo Financial's case study explicitly stated they eliminated separate staging environments using Preview Deployments, allowing multiple teams to test and collaborate simultaneously. This directly answered my concern about developer workflow conflicts.     |
| Does the AI Cloud actually simplify ML model deployment or is it just marketing?                  | Yes     | Yes        | The detailed AI Cloud section showed real infrastructure components - AI Gateway, Fluid Compute, Sandbox - with specific capabilities. The marketplace integration and technical documentation links proved it's legitimate infrastructure, not just marketing. |
| What happens if Vercel has an outage - how reliable is this compared to managing our own servers? | Yes     | Yes        | Neo Financial's case study mentioned 99.99% SLA, global CDN, and 0.30% service uptime improvement. Enterprise features included multi-region compute and failover, showing better reliability than our self-managed infrastructure.                             |

## Persona 2: Sarah Okafor, 41

Researching modern web platform for marketing sites (6-week deadline, needs fast pages, team includes non-developers) -- Denver, CO

### Personal Description

Sarah has an MBA and runs marketing for a mid-sized healthcare software company while doing freelance consulting on the side. She's not a developer but has learned to work closely with technical teams and understands enough about web development to have informed conversations. She manages several marketing websites and landing pages, currently using WordPress and basic

hosting providers. Sarah is frustrated with slow page loads affecting her conversion rates and has been reading about modern web technologies that promise better performance.

## **Situation**

Sarah's consulting client, a growing SaaS company, needs to launch a series of product landing pages quickly for an upcoming product release in 6 weeks. Their current WordPress setup is slow and their developer keeps talking about 'static site generators' and 'edge computing' as solutions. The developer suggested Vercel as a platform that could deliver fast-loading pages and easy content updates. Sarah needs to understand what Vercel offers from a business perspective - costs, ease of use for non-technical team members, and whether it can actually deliver the performance improvements they need.

## **Key Questions**

- Can non-technical team members easily update content on Vercel-hosted sites?
- How much faster will our pages actually load compared to traditional WordPress hosting?
- What's the total cost compared to our current hosting + plugins setup?
- Can we easily integrate with our existing analytics, email marketing, and CRM tools?
- How quickly can we get landing pages live - days or weeks?
- If our developer leaves, how hard is it to find someone else who knows this platform?
- Can we A/B test different page versions easily?
- What happens to SEO rankings when we migrate from WordPress?

## **What They Need**

Sarah needs business-focused explanations that connect technical capabilities to marketing outcomes. She wants case studies showing ROI, clear pricing information, and reassurance that this won't create new dependencies on hard-to-find technical expertise. She needs to understand both the benefits and the practical challenges of switching platforms.

## **Visit Experience**

I started by checking Vercel's pricing since budget is always a concern for our small team. The Pro plan at \$20/month seemed reasonable compared to what we're paying for WordPress hosting plus all our plugins. Then I dove into their customer case studies and found exactly what I needed - PAIGE's story showed a 22% revenue increase and 76% conversion rate improvement, which got me excited about the potential business impact. I spent time exploring their templates and found ready-to-deploy options like the Lead Agent for lead capture, which could solve our immediate need for product landing pages. The Marketing Sites section was a goldmine - it showed specific metrics like 77% increase in page speed and 30% increased conversions, directly answering my performance concerns. However, I struggled to find clear information about content management workflows for non-technical team members. I searched through their knowledge base and explored various sections, but never found concrete details about how our marketing team could update content without developer involvement. The site felt very developer-focused, which made me worry about our team's ability to maintain sites independently.

### **Questions Answered by the Site**

The site excellently answered my questions about performance improvements and costs. I found specific metrics showing 77% faster page speeds and 30% conversion increases in the Marketing Sites section, plus clear pricing at \$20/month for the Pro plan. The templates section showed I could deploy landing pages in days using ready-made solutions like the Lead Agent template. However, the site completely failed to address content management workflows for non-technical users, integration specifics with existing marketing tools, A/B testing capabilities, or SEO migration concerns. Despite extensive searching through documentation, knowledge base, and solution pages, these critical business workflow questions remained unanswered. The content was heavily technical and developer-oriented, leaving gaps around day-to-day operational concerns for marketing teams.

### **Reaction**

I was initially impressed by the concrete performance metrics and business results - seeing PAIGE's 22% revenue increase and the specific speed improvements gave me confidence in the platform's capabilities. The professional design and clear value propositions made me trust this as a serious business solution. However, I became increasingly frustrated as I couldn't find answers to basic operational questions about content management and team workflows. The

developer-centric focus made me worry that our marketing team would struggle with day-to-day site maintenance, which could create new dependencies and bottlenecks.

## Decision & Next Steps

I'm going to schedule a demo call with their sales team to get specific answers about content management workflows and integrations before making a recommendation to my team. The performance benefits and cost structure are compelling, but I need clarity on operational concerns before we can move forward. I'll also research headless CMS options that could work with Vercel to solve the content management challenge for our non-technical team members.

## Interaction Log

| #  | Action      | Target                                                              | Result                                                        |
|----|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | link        | Pricing                                                             | navigated to Vercel Pricing: Hobby, Pro, and Enterprise plans |
| 2  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/67                                  |
| 3  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/67                                  |
| 4  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/67                                  |
| 5  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/67                                  |
| 6  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 6/67                                  |
| 7  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 7/67                                  |
| 8  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 8/67                                  |
| 9  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 9/67                                  |
| 10 | link        | Log In                                                              | navigated to Login - Vercel                                   |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                                                                                                                  | Result                                                                                |
|----|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a>                                                                                                                     | navigated back                                                                        |
| 12 | menu_toggle | Resources                                                                                                                                                                               | opened menu toggle 'Resources', revealing 13 new option(s)                            |
| 13 | link        | Customers Trusted by the best teams                                                                                                                                                     | navigated to Vercel Customers and Case Studies                                        |
| 14 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/customers">https://vercel.com/customers</a>                                                                                                                 | scrolled down to screen 2/28                                                          |
| 15 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/customers">https://vercel.com/customers</a>                                                                                                                 | scrolled down to screen 3/28                                                          |
| 16 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/customers">https://vercel.com/customers</a>                                                                                                                 | scrolled down to screen 4/28                                                          |
| 17 | link        | paige Logo With Vercel, PAIGE boosted their Black Friday revenue by 22% and incr                                                                                                        | navigated to How PAIGE grew revenue by 22% with Shopify, Next.js, and Vercel - Vercel |
| 18 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/29                                                          |
| 19 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/29                                                          |
| 20 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/29                                                          |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                                                                                                                  | Result                                                            |
|----|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/29                                      |
| 22 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 6/29                                      |
| 23 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel">https://vercel.com/blog/how-paige-grew-revenue-by-22-with-shopify-next-js-and-vercel</a> | scrolled down to screen 7/29                                      |
| 24 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/customers">https://vercel.com/customers</a>                                                                                                                 | navigated back                                                    |
| 25 | menu_toggle | Resources                                                                                                                                                                               | opened menu toggle 'Resources', revealing text content            |
| 26 | link        | Knowledge Base Find help quickly                                                                                                                                                        | navigated to Vercel Knowledge Base: Guides, Videos, and Tutorials |
| 27 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/kb">https://vercel.com/kb</a>                                                                                                                               | scrolled down to screen 2/22                                      |
| 28 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/kb">https://vercel.com/kb</a>                                                                                                                               | scrolled down to screen 3/22                                      |
| 29 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/kb">https://vercel.com/kb</a>                                                                                                                               | scrolled down to screen 4/22                                      |
| 30 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/kb">https://vercel.com/kb</a>                                                                                                                               | scrolled down to screen 5/22                                      |
| 31 | button      | Search Knowledge Base ? K                                                                                                                                                               | content expanded on page                                          |

| #  | Action       | Target                                                                                                                              | Result                                                                                        |
|----|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 32 | search       | Global Command Menu                                                                                                                 | searched for 'content management team collaboration'                                          |
| 33 | link         | Templates                                                                                                                           | navigated to Templates - Vercel                                                               |
| 34 | scroll_down  | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | scrolled down to screen 2/15                                                                  |
| 35 | search       | Search                                                                                                                              | searched for 'landing page'                                                                   |
| 36 | scroll_down  | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | scrolled down to screen 2/15                                                                  |
| 37 | scroll_down  | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | scrolled down to screen 3/15                                                                  |
| 38 | button       | Use Case                                                                                                                            | interactive element revealed                                                                  |
| 39 | menu_toggle  | Use Case                                                                                                                            | opened menu toggle 'Use Case', revealing text content                                         |
| 40 | scroll_down  | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | scrolled down to screen 4/15                                                                  |
| 41 | scroll_down  | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | scrolled down to screen 5/15                                                                  |
| 42 | link         | Lead Agent An inbound lead qualification and research agent built with Next.js,                                                     | navigated to Lead Agent - Vercel                                                              |
| 43 | step_offsite | View Demo                                                                                                                           | stepped off-site to <a href="https://lead-agent.vercel.sh/">https://lead-agent.vercel.sh/</a> |
| 44 | back         | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent">https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent</a> | navigated back                                                                                |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                                                              | Result                                                     |
|----|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 45 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent">https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/35                               |
| 46 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent">https://vercel.com/templates/next.js/lead-processing-agent</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/35                               |
| 47 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/templates">https://vercel.com/templates</a>                                                             | navigated back                                             |
| 48 | menu_toggle | Solutions                                                                                                                           | opened menu toggle 'Solutions', revealing 10 new option(s) |
| 49 | link        | Marketing Sites<br>Launch campaigns fast                                                                                            | navigated to Marketing Sites                               |
| 50 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites">https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites</a>                             | scrolled down to screen 2/36                               |
| 51 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites">https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites</a>                             | scrolled down to screen 3/36                               |
| 52 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites">https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites</a>                             | scrolled down to screen 4/36                               |
| 53 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites">https://vercel.com/solutions/marketing-sites</a>                             | scrolled down to screen 5/36                               |
| 54 | link        | Talk to an Expert                                                                                                                   | navigated to Talk to our Sales team                        |
| 55 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/contact/sales">https://vercel.com/contact/sales</a>                                                     | scrolled down to screen 2/12                               |
| 56 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/contact/sales">https://vercel.com/contact/sales</a>                                                     | scrolled down to screen 3/12                               |
| 57 | leave       |                                                                                                                                     | left the website                                           |

## Questions Resolved

| Question                                                                                | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can non-technical team members easily update content on Vercel-hosted sites?            | No      | —          | Despite searching through documentation, knowledge base, templates, and solution pages, I found no clear information about content management workflows for non-technical users. The site was heavily developer-focused without addressing day-to-day content editing processes. |
| How much faster will our pages actually load compared to traditional WordPress hosting? | Yes     | Yes        | The Marketing Sites section provided specific metrics showing 77% increase in page speed and 50% better Core Web Vitals. This concrete data directly answered my performance concerns about WordPress site speeds.                                                               |
| What's the total cost compared to our current hosting + plugins setup?                  | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing page clearly showed Pro plan at \$20/month with \$20 included usage credit. Compared to our current WordPress hosting plus multiple plugin subscriptions, this appears cost-competitive with potentially better value.                                               |
| Can we easily integrate with our existing analytics, email marketing, and CRM tools?    | No      | —          | I searched through solution pages, templates, and documentation but found no specific information about third-party marketing tool integrations. The backend section mentioned APIs but lacked details about common marketing integrations.                                      |

| Question                                                                              | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How quickly can we get landing pages live - days or weeks?                            | Yes     | Yes        | The templates section showed ready-to-deploy solutions like the Lead Agent template with a 'Deploy' button, and the Marketing Sites tagline 'Launch campaigns fast' suggested rapid deployment. This indicates days rather than weeks for our 6-week product timeline. |
| If our developer leaves, how hard is it to find someone else who knows this platform? | No      | —          | The site didn't address talent availability or learning curve for new developers. While I saw mentions of Next.js (which is popular), there was no information about developer ecosystem size or hiring considerations.                                                |
| Can we A/B test different page versions easily?                                       | No      | —          | Despite exploring marketing-focused sections and searching through documentation, I found no mention of A/B testing capabilities or experimentation features that would be crucial for optimizing our landing pages.                                                   |
| What happens to SEO rankings when we migrate from WordPress?                          | No      | —          | I searched through knowledge base and documentation but found no information about SEO preservation during migration or best practices for maintaining search rankings when switching from WordPress to Vercel.                                                        |

### Persona 3: David Kim, 34

Exploring AI-focused development platform (Solo developer, tight budget under \$200/month, building AI writing tool) -- Portland, OR

#### Personal Description

David is a self-taught developer who left his corporate job two years ago to build indie web apps and sell programming courses. He has a philosophy degree but learned to code through online resources and bootcamps. David is scrappy and

cost-conscious, often choosing open-source tools and budget hosting options. He's built several small web apps using various frameworks but struggles with the complexity of deployment and scaling. He's particularly interested in AI applications but finds the infrastructure setup intimidating and expensive.

## **Situation**

David is building his most ambitious project yet - an AI-powered writing assistant for content creators, which he plans to launch as a SaaS product. He's been cobbling together various AI APIs and services, but the deployment and scaling complexity is becoming overwhelming. A fellow indie developer in an online community recommended Vercel's AI Cloud features, claiming it simplified their AI app deployment. David has a tight budget (under \$200/month initially) and needs to understand if Vercel can help him launch faster while keeping costs low until he gets paying customers.

## **Key Questions**

- Can I actually build and deploy AI apps on Vercel without a big upfront investment?
- How does the pricing work if my app suddenly gets popular - will I get hit with huge bills?
- Is this too enterprise-focused for a solo developer, or do indie developers actually use this?
- Can I integrate multiple AI models without managing separate API keys and endpoints?
- How hard is it to set up user authentication and payments on this platform?
- Will I be locked into Vercel's ecosystem, or can I move my app elsewhere later?
- Do I need to know DevOps and infrastructure management to use this effectively?
- Are there any hidden costs or limitations that only show up after you're committed?

## **What They Need**

David needs honest, practical guidance about costs and complexity from someone who understands budget constraints. He wants to see examples from other solo developers and clear documentation that doesn't assume enterprise-level resources. He needs confidence that he can start small and scale gradually without getting overwhelmed by complexity or surprise costs.

## Visit Experience

I went into this research feeling pretty skeptical about Vercel - another platform promising to solve all my problems as a solo developer trying to build an AI writing assistant. But honestly, I was pleasantly surprised by what I found. I started on the pricing page and immediately saw something encouraging: a free Hobby tier and Pro at just \$20/month with spend limits you can set yourself. That was huge for me since my biggest fear was getting slammed with unexpected bills if my app took off. When I dug into the AI Gateway documentation, I discovered they offer \$5/month in free AI credits and use a pay-as-you-go model with zero markup - meaning I only pay the actual AI provider costs. The 'Ask AI' feature helped me understand they support all major frameworks like Next.js and have simple three-step deployment. What really sold me was finding the AI Gateway that acts as a single endpoint for multiple AI models - exactly what I needed to avoid juggling separate API keys for different providers. The getting started guide showed prerequisites of just Node.js 18+ and a Vercel account, with deployment being as simple as 'npm install', 'vercel login', and 'vercel deploy'. Even better, they explicitly mention 'no lock-in' and the ability to use your own API keys, addressing my vendor lock-in concerns.

## Questions Answered by the Site

Vercel's documentation answered most of my critical questions very well, particularly around pricing structure and technical complexity. The AI Gateway pricing page clearly explained the free tier with \$5 monthly credits, pay-as-you-go billing with no markup, and the ability to set spend limits. The getting started guide showed minimal technical requirements and simple deployment steps, addressing my DevOps concerns. The AI Gateway models page demonstrated comprehensive support for multiple AI providers through a unified endpoint. However, I couldn't find specific information about user authentication and payment integration for SaaS applications - I looked for integrations documentation but didn't find comprehensive coverage of auth providers like Auth0 or payment processors like Stripe. The site also didn't provide concrete examples of indie developers using the platform, though the pricing structure clearly supports solo developers.

## Reaction

I felt genuinely relieved and excited as I browsed through Vercel's documentation. After struggling with complex cloud setups before, seeing such straightforward pricing and deployment processes was refreshing. The transparency around costs and the explicit 'no lock-in' policy built real trust for me. I was particularly

impressed by how they've thought about solo developers - the free tier, reasonable Pro pricing, and spend controls show they understand bootstrap constraints. The only mild frustration was not finding clear guidance on auth and payments, but the core platform capabilities exceeded my expectations.

## Decision & Next Steps

I'm definitely going to sign up for a free Vercel account and start experimenting with their AI Gateway using my existing OpenAI API key. The risk is essentially zero with the free tier, and I can build a prototype of my writing assistant to validate the platform before committing to paid plans. For authentication and payments, I'll research integrating Auth0 and Stripe separately since those are standard solutions that should work with any Node.js deployment.

## Interaction Log

| #  | Action      | Target                                                              | Result                                                        |
|----|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | link        | Pricing                                                             | navigated to Vercel Pricing: Hobby, Pro, and Enterprise plans |
| 2  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/67                                  |
| 3  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 3/67                                  |
| 4  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 4/67                                  |
| 5  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 5/67                                  |
| 6  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 6/67                                  |
| 7  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 7/67                                  |
| 8  | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/pricing">https://vercel.com/pricing</a> | scrolled down to screen 8/67                                  |
| 9  | button      | Ask AI                                                              | content expanded on page                                      |
| 10 | button      | What can I deploy with Vercel?                                      | content expanded on page                                      |

| #  | Action             | Target                                                                                                                        | Result                                                    |
|----|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 11 | widget_interaction | Ask a question...                                                                                                             | couldn't operate widget 'Ask a question...'               |
| 12 | menu_toggle        | Products                                                                                                                      | opened menu toggle 'Products', revealing 15 new option(s) |
| 13 | link               | AI Gateway One endpoint, all your models                                                                                      | navigated to AI Gateway                                   |
| 14 | link               | Read the Docs                                                                                                                 | navigated to AI Gateway                                   |
| 15 | link               | Pricing                                                                                                                       | navigated to Pricing                                      |
| 16 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing</a>                           | scrolled down to screen 2/17                              |
| 17 | link               | Free and paid tiers                                                                                                           | jumped to anchor #free-and-paid-tiers (screen 2/17)       |
| 18 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing</a>                           | scrolled down to screen 3/17                              |
| 19 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/pricing</a>                           | scrolled down to screen 4/17                              |
| 20 | link               | Models & Providers                                                                                                            | navigated to Models & Providers                           |
| 21 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers</a> | scrolled down to screen 2/72                              |
| 22 | link               | AI Gateway models page                                                                                                        | navigated to Browse AI Gateway Models                     |
| 23 | scroll_down        | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 2/95                              |

| #  | Action      | Target                                                                                                                        | Result                                        |
|----|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 24 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 3/95                  |
| 25 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 4/95                  |
| 26 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 5/95                  |
| 27 | search      | Search                                                                                                                        | searched for 'GPT'                            |
| 28 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 2/95                  |
| 29 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 3/95                  |
| 30 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models">https://vercel.com/ai-gateway/models</a>                                       | scrolled down to screen 4/95                  |
| 31 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers</a> | navigated back                                |
| 32 | link        | Getting Started                                                                                                               | navigated to Getting started with Vercel      |
| 33 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/getting-started-with-vercel">https://vercel.com/docs/getting-started-with-vercel</a>         | scrolled down to screen 2/23                  |
| 34 | scroll_down | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/getting-started-with-vercel">https://vercel.com/docs/getting-started-with-vercel</a>         | scrolled down to screen 3/23                  |
| 35 | link        | Prerequisites                                                                                                                 | jumped to anchor #prerequisites (screen 3/23) |
| 36 | back        | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers</a> | navigated back                                |
| 37 | link        | Flags                                                                                                                         | navigated to Flags                            |

| #  | Action | Target                                                                                                                        | Result           |
|----|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 38 | back   | <a href="https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers">https://vercel.com/docs/ai-gateway/models-and-providers</a> | navigated back   |
| 39 | leave  |                                                                                                                               | left the website |

## Questions Resolved

| Question                                                                                       | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can I actually build and deploy AI apps on Vercel without a big upfront investment?            | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing page showed a completely free Hobby tier for getting started, plus the AI Gateway offers \$5/month in free credits with pay-as-you-go pricing. The getting started guide confirmed deployment requires only basic Node.js knowledge and a few CLI commands. |
| How does the pricing work if my app suddenly gets popular - will I get hit with huge bills?    | Yes     | Yes        | The AI Gateway documentation explicitly states you can 'set your own spend limits' and uses pay-as-you-go pricing with 'zero markup' on AI model costs. This gives me control over costs and predictable billing based on actual usage.                                 |
| Is this too enterprise-focused for a solo developer, or do indie developers actually use this? | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing structure with a free tier and \$20/month Pro plan clearly targets individual developers. The getting started guide emphasizes simplicity with minimal prerequisites, and the AI Gateway's free credits make it accessible for bootstrapped projects.       |

| Question                                                                             | Found ? | Satisfied? | How                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Can I integrate multiple AI models without managing separate API keys and endpoints? | Yes     | Yes        | The AI Gateway provides exactly this - a single endpoint for accessing multiple AI providers and models. The documentation showed it supports text, image, video, and other model types from various providers through one unified API.                                          |
| How hard is it to set up user authentication and payments on this platform?          | No      | —          | I couldn't find comprehensive documentation about integrating authentication providers or payment processors. While I saw references to integrations and authentication sections, I didn't locate specific guidance for setting up user auth and payments for SaaS applications. |
| Will I be locked into Vercel's ecosystem, or can I move my app elsewhere later?      | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing documentation explicitly states 'No lock-in' as a feature, and the AI Gateway supports bringing your own API keys (BYOK). Since they support standard frameworks like Next.js and Node.js, migration should be straightforward.                                      |
| Do I need to know DevOps and infrastructure management to use this effectively?      | Yes     | Yes        | The getting started guide shows deployment is just three simple CLI commands with minimal prerequisites (Node.js 18+ and account signup). The platform handles infrastructure automatically, and they even offer dashboard deployment options beyond CLI.                        |
| Are there any hidden costs or limitations that only show up after you're committed?  | Yes     | Yes        | The pricing documentation was very transparent about costs, showing the transition from free to paid tiers and explaining the pay-as-you-go model. The ability to set spend limits and the 'zero markup' policy on AI costs suggest no hidden fees.                              |